

Boeing Starliner to return on Earth this week without Sunita Williams and Butch Wilmore

NASA is set to provide live coverage of Boeing's Starliner spacecraft as it departs the International Space Station (ISS) and returns to Earth this weekend. Initially, the Starliner was supposed



to bring astronauts Sunita Williams and Butch Wilmore back home. However, due to technical issues, the spacecraft will now return

uncrewed. The Starliner is scheduled to autonomously undock from the ISS around 6:04 PM EDT on September 6. After undocking, it will begin its journey back to Earth, aiming for a landing at White Sands Space Harbor in New Mexico at approximately 12:03 PM EDT on September 7. NASA will stream the event live on NASA+, the NASA app, and the agency's website. Williams and Wilmore launched aboard the Starliner on June 5 for what was originally planned as an eight-day mission. However, due to issues with the spacecraft's thrusters and helium systems, their stay on the ISS was extended.

<https://bit.ly/3MXmdN3>

NASA finally discovers Earth's long-sought global electric field

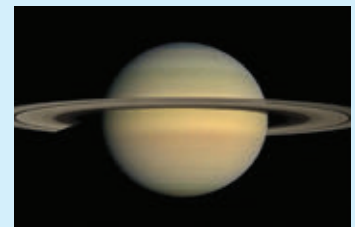
For the first time, scientists have measured a planet-wide electric field, known as the ambipolar electric field. This breakthrough, achieved through NASA's Endurance mission, sheds new light on a fundamental aspect of our planet's atmosphere. "Using observations from a NASA suborbital rocket, an international team of scientists has, for the first time, successfully measured a planet-wide electric field thought to be as fundamental to Earth as its gravity and magnetic fields. Known as the ambipolar electric field, scientists first hypothesised over 60 years ago that it drove how our planet's atmosphere



can escape above Earth's North and South Poles," NASA said. Since the 1960s, researchers have observed particles escaping Earth's atmosphere at the poles. The mystery was that something was clearly drawing these particles out of the atmosphere, and an electric field was suspected to be the cause. <https://bit.ly/3MU5wSO>

Saturn's rings to disappear from Earth's sight in March 2025

A cosmic event is set to occur in March 2025: Saturn's iconic rings will become almost invisible to observers on Earth. This phenomenon happens because Saturn's rings will be aligned edge-on to our point of view. Saturn's axis, like Earth, is tilted. For half of its year, the planet tilts towards the Sun, lighting up the top of its rings. For the other



half, it leans away, with the Sun shining on its south pole and the bottom of the rings, reports Earth.com.

Twice during its orbit, Saturn's rings are seen edge-on to the Sun, which causes what's known as a ring "equinox." This brief period gives equal sunlight to both the northern and southern hemispheres of the planet. It's important to note that this change isn't permanent. Saturn's orbit around the Sun takes about 29.5 years, so this is a temporary event. After March 2025, Saturn's tilt will bring the rings back into view, but they'll disappear again in November 2025.

<https://bit.ly/3MXmjEp>